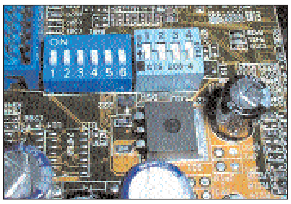
THE RIGHT WAY TO INSTALL A PROCESSOR

STEP 1 Preparing the motherboard

Set your motherboard to run at the correct core voltage, bus frequency and clock multiplier settings by consulting the manual. In some cases, you may need to do this through the DIP switches on the motherboard or



DIP switches to set the correct bus frequency and clock multiplier settings

the Frequency/Voltage settings in the BIOS.

STEP 2 Preparing the processor

Next, apply thermal paste on your processor by using a thin plastic visiting card—a plastic card is best suited to spreading the paste smoothly all across the surface of the processor core. You can also extend this paste around the

Smoothly apply the thermal paste to the processor core so that there are no air bubbles

core, but smoothen out the paste such that there are no air bubbles. Also, the paste should be in contact with every portion of the processor core.

STEP 3 Preparing the heatsink

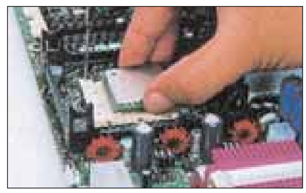
Next, locate the region on the underside of the heatsink where the processor is going to touch the processor core. This is usually in the centre of the flat area of the heatsink. Once you have ascertained this

On the heatsink, apply thermal paste on the area that will be in contact with the processor core

zone, wipe it clean of any dust. Then evenly spread some thermal paste, carefully avoiding any air bubbles.

STEP 4 Seat the processor in the socket

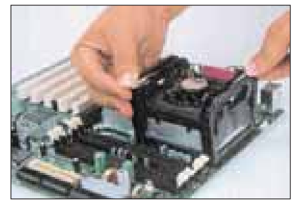
Clamp the processor firmly into the socket on the motherboard and make sure that it is correctly aligned with the pins. Do so without applying too much force on the processor.



Firmly seat the processor in the motherboard socket

STEP 5 Install the heatsink

Place the heatsink on the processor gently, but firmly—take care not to damage the core of the processor. Make sure that the heatsink is seated such that it is in complete contact with the processor core, then fasten the clasps into



Make sure the heatsink is firmly latched onto processor socket

the retention hooks of the processor socket to ensure that it is in firm contact with the processor.

STEP 6 Connect the CPU fan

Finally, connect the CPU fan on the correct point on the motherboard. Make sure that the heatsink assembly is firmly seated—there should be no play in it.

There, you're now good to go!

Connect the CPU fan to the motherboard

10 POWER TIPS FOR ATHLON-BASED SYSTEMS

Since you belong to the AMD camp, consider the following steps to build a reliable and high-performance system

1 Take care while mounting the processor

AMD processors have a very delicate processor core as the silicon is exposed on top of the chip. Therefore, great care needs to be taken to ensure that the processor is not damaged by rough and incorrect installation of the heatsink. Ensure that the heatsink is installed flat down—do not angle it or try to slide it in, as this would graze the top of the processor or chip its sides and render it useless.

2 Keep it cool

AMD processors are extremely susceptible to heat and it is critical that they be kept cool. Therefore, the CPU has to be plugged in before powering on the system, otherwise the CPU and possibly the motherboard would be damaged within seconds of switching on the system. Also see that the CPU fan is correctly mounted on the system using thermal paste so that it maintains good contact between the heatsink and the processor *(refer to the box, 'The Right Way to Install a Processor', for more details on how to do this).*